

Bedtime Tales

Counting Stars to Sleep



KIDS BOOK VIDEOS



Lena the lamb was wide awake. She had counted sheep already — one sheep, two sheep, three sheep — but it did not work at all. She felt frustrated.

She climbed out of bed and went to the window. The night sky was full of stars, hundreds of tiny lights twinkling down at her. Lena had an idea: she would count stars instead of sheep.



"One twinkling star," she whispered. A star near the moon blinked at her. "Two twinkling stars." Another star twinkled back. Lena felt a little calmer already.

"Three twinkling stars," she whispered. "Four twinkling stars." The stars seemed to shine brighter as she counted, like they were happy to be noticed.



"Count with me, one, two, three," sang a soft voice. It was her grandmother, standing in the doorway. Grandma wrapped a shawl around Lena's shoulders.

"Five twinkling stars," Lena whispered. "Six twinkling stars." Grandma counted with her, their voices soft as feathers.



"Count with me, one, two, three," Grandma sang again.

"Seven twinkling stars," yawned Lena, a tiny yawn escaping.

"Eight twinkling stars." Her eyelids felt heavy. Counting was making her sleepy.



Grandma lifted Lena back into bed and tucked the blanket snugly. Through the window, the stars kept twinkling. Lena could still see them from her pillow.



"Nine twinkling stars," whispered Lena, her voice very quiet now. "Ten twinkling stars."



"Count with me, one, two, three," Grandma sang one last time.



Lena smiled in the dark. She had counted ten whole stars. She felt proud and peaceful, her body heavy like a warm stone, her breathing slow.



The stars twinkled on without her. They did not mind — they would be there tomorrow night too, and Lena could count them all over again.



Sleep now, little lamb. You counted the stars beautifully. Let their twinkling rock you into the softest dreams.

Slow, gentle counting can turn a restless mind into a sleepy one.

The End

